Seeing Through Photographs

Today's goal • 3/3 items

Module 1
Introduction to Seeing Through Photographs

Module 2
One Subject, Many Perspectives

Part I: Introduction
- Introduction to Module 1 — Reading • 2 min
- Artistic Equivalents — Reading • 2 min
- Vik Muniz on Photographing the Familiar — Video • 3 min

Part II: Telescopes and Cameras
- Introduction to Part II: Surface, Scale, and Technology — Video • 2 min
- Practical Scenario — Real-world application • 5 min
- Moons and Surfaces — Reading • 5 min
- Hear More: Sarah Meister on Eugène Atget. Pendant l'éclipse. 1912 — Video • 3 min
- Hear More: Liz Deschenes on Tilt/Swing (360° field of vision, version 1), 2009 — Video • 1 min
- Surface, Scale, Technology — Dialogue • 15 min

Part III: Seeing the Unseen
- Introduction to Part III: Man on the Moon — Video • 2 min
- Photographs by NASA — Reading • 2 min
- Hear More: Sarah Meister on U.S.G.S. and NASA, Surveyor III. Surface of the Moon, Day 319, W-F. 1967 — Video • 1 min
- Practical Scenario — Real-world application • 5 min
- Who Does the Moon Belong To? — Reading • 4 min

Part IV: It's Only a Paper Moon
- Introduction to Part IV: Vernacular and Fine Art Photographs of the Moon — Video • 3 min
- Moon Phases — Reading • 6 min
- Hear More: Sarah Meister on Ansel Adams. Moonrise, Hernandez, New Mexico. 1941 — Video • 3 min
- Man on the Moon and Paper Moons — Dialogue • 15 min

Part V: Review and Respond
- Optional Readings and Resources — Reading • 10 min
- Practice Memory Check — Practice Assignment • Grade: 100%
- Optional Discussion Prompts and Creative Challenges — Reading • 10 min

Module 3
Documents and the Documentary

Part I: Introduction
- Introduction to Module 3 — Reading • 2 min
- Sarah Meister on Documents and the Documentary — Video • 3 min

Part II: Framing Reality
- Facts and Fictions — Reading • 6 min
- Fictions and Facts — Reading • 6 min
- Practical Scenario — Real-world application • 5 min
- Hear More: Mike Mandel on Evidence, 1977 — Video • 4 min
- Hear More: Thomas Demand on Room (Zimmer), 1996 — Video • 1 min

Part III: Words and Pictures
- Artist Spotlight: Dorothea Lange — Reading • 4 min
- Practical Scenario — Real-world application • 5 min
- Hear More: Sarah Meister on Dorothea Lange. Migrant Mother. 1936 — Video • 2 min
- Hear More: Sarah Meister on Dorothea Lange. On the Road to Los Angeles, California. March 1937 — Video • 1 min
- Artist Spotlight: Gordon Parks — Reading • 4 min

Part IV: Focus on New Documents, 1967
- Introduction to Part IV: Sarah Meister on New Documents — Video • 3 min
- New Documents: Arbus, Friedlander, and Winogrand — Reading • 4 min

Part V: Review and Respond
- Practice Memory Check — Practice Assignment • Grade: 100%
- Optional Discussion Prompts and Creative Challenges — Reading • 10 min
- Optional Readings and Resources — Reading • 10 min

Module 4
One and Another

Part I: Introduction
- Introduction to Module 4 — Reading • 2 min
- Sarah Meister on Photography and Multiplicity — Video • 2 min

Part II: Albums and Books
- Artwork Spotlight: Frances Benjamin Johnston's The Hampton Album, 1899-1900 — Reading • 2 min
- Hear More: Sarah Meister on Frances Benjamin Johnston. The Hampton Album. 1899-1900 — Video • 1 min
- Practical Scenario — Real-world application • 5 min
- Photo Books — Reading • 8 min

Part III: Bodies of Work
- Photo Series — Reading • 13 min
- Hear More: Nicholas Nixon on The Brown Sisters, 1975–2022 — Video • 1 min
- Practical Scenario — Real-world application • 5 min
- Hear More: Sohrab Hura on Snow, 2015–ongoing — Video • 5 min

Part IV: One from Many
- One from Many — Reading • 8 min
- Hear More: Irina Rozovsky on Miracle Center, 2019–ongoing — Video • 5 min

Part V: Review and Respond
- Practice Memory Check — Practice Assignment • 30 min
- Optional Discussion Prompts and Creative Challenges — Reading • 10 min
- Optional Readings and Resources — Reading • 10 min
- Optional Mid-Course Survey — Reading • 5 min

Module 5
Constructing Narratives, Challenging Histories

Module 6
Pictures of People

Module 7
Ocean of Images

One from Many

0:19 / 7:14 1x

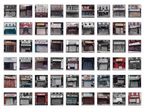
Alfred Stieglitz



Alfred Stieglitz, *Georgia O'Keeffe – Hands and Thimble*. 1919. Palladium print, 9 5/16 × 7 5/8" (23.6 × 19.4 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Gift of David H. McAlpin. © 2020 Estate of Alfred Stieglitz/Artists Rights Society (ARS), New York

Artist and arts impresario Alfred Stieglitz photographed the artist Georgia O'Keeffe extensively over the course of their long relationship. These photographs of O'Keeffe range from closely framed pictures of her face to isolated portraits of her hands, either cutting up fruit, gripping a wheel, or in this case, modeling a polished metal thimble. Stieglitz considered these images as stand-ins for her whole person, and the totality of images he took of her over time offer a tender, complex, and ultimately irreducible composite portrait of O'Keeffe.

Zoe Leonard



Zoe Leonard. *Analogue*. 1998–2009. Chromogenic color prints and gelatin silver prints, each 11 × 11" (27.9 × 27.9 cm). *Analogue* was made possible through the Artist's Residency program at the Wexner Center for the Arts at The Ohio State University. The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Acquired through the generosity of the Contemporary Arts Council of The Museum of Modern Art, the Fund for the Twenty-First Century, The Modern Women's Fund, and Carol Appel. © 2020 Zoe Leonard



Detail from Zoe Leonard. *Analogue*. 1998-2009.

Deeply influenced by Eugène Atget and Walker Evans, Zoe Leonard inflected this sweeping documentary project with poetry and personal meaning. Titled to evoke a bygone era, Analogue consists of 412 individual photographs arranged in grids and organized into a loose narrative told in 25 chapters. Though each of the images merits individual consideration, Leonard conceived them as parts of a whole, using ordering and repetition to extend and enrich their meaning. Together, they reveal the changing character of her neighborhood on Manhattan's Lower East Side while witnessing the emergence of the global rag trade and the boom in the recycled merchandise business.

Christina Fernandez



Christina Fernandez. *Maria's Great Expedition*. 1995–96. Five gelatin silver prints, one chromogenic color print, one pigmented inkjet print, and texts, each print 20 × 16" (50.8 × 40.6 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. The Modern Women's Fund. © 2020 Christina Fernandez



Detail from Christina Fernandez. *Maria's Great Expedition*. 1995–96.

In this sweeping yet personal narrative, the artist poses in the guise of her great-grandmother, María Gonzales, the first member of Christina Fernandez's family to migrate to the United States from Mexico. Each portrait is carefully staged, with props and clues reflecting the conventions of the period it represents as well as key events in María's life. Through images and text, Fernandez chronicles María's saga throughout the first half of the twentieth century, across borders and back again, relaying the circumstances of her own family and responding to a broader history of immigrant experience.

This photo of María waiting by the train tracks is accompanied by a text titled "1927, Going back to Morelia" where Fernandez writes:

"In Avon, María persuaded a landowner to let her sharecrop a parcel of his land. She hired workers to plant and harvest lettuce, providing room and board and a small percentage of the profits. Eventually María was able to buy a touring car and a truck to transport the lettuce to market.

"In 1927, María's brother, Francisco, who had found her living in Avon, convinced María to visit her mother who was still alive and living in Morelia. He brought María letters from her mother expressing sadness about María's absence. They traveled by train to Morelia, where the railroads had been bombed out by the Revolution, and traveled by horseback to get to the ranch. For her visit, María wore a short dress and put on lipstick so people would know she was from the U.S. Her family threw a big party for her homecoming and begged her to stay. She decided to return to Colorado.

"The Immigration Acts of 1921 and 1924 severely limited Southern and Eastern European and Asian immigration. Congressmen argued against the utilization of Mexican immigrant labor to appease their constituencies, while industrialists favored it for reasons of profit. Mexicans were denigrated in the press but continued to fill the labor gaps created by the ever fluctuating U.S. economy and immigration policy. The family re-entered the U.S., earning the money to return to Avon by selling newspapers in El Paso."

View the rest of the images in this work and read an interview with the artist.

Irina Rozovsky



Irina Rozovsky. Untitled from the series Miracle Center. 2019–ongoing. Pigmented inkjet prints, repurposed frame, 3 1/8 × 6 × 3" (7.9 × 15.2 × 7.6 cm). Photo courtesy the artist. © 2020 Irina Rozovsky

According to Irina Rozovsky, Miracle Center is an "invitation to play with time and visual space." A collection of precious objects, the artist created these works by inserting her own photographs into decades-old frames that she found on eBay or through antique sales, reinvigorating them and lending permanence to pictures that may otherwise only exist as digital information stored on her iPhone or in the cloud. Many of the prints are housed in what were once known as "travel frames," which could be slipped into a suitcase or a coat pocket and carried on journeys to serve as mementos of loved ones at home. She is especially drawn to frames with multiple windows, allowing her to create new meanings by linking previously-unrelated pictures.

Iñaki Bonillas



Iñaki Bonillas. *Marginalia 7*. 2019. Pigmented inkjet print, 50 13/16 × 43 5/16" (129 × 110 cm). Photo courtesy the artist and kurimanzutto, Mexico City and New York. © 2020 Iñaki Bonillas

Marginalia are the marks and notes jotted on the margins of books. Inspired by this practice and the tendency to leave untouched the margins of images, Iñaki Bonillas pulled photo reproductions from the books on his shelves and traced a path from the white border of one image to that of another threading them together into a new narrative. In *Marginalia 7*, Bonillas investigates the connections between the margins of photographs depicting sculptures. Among the books he consulted to make this work is an old catalogue showcasing the collection of The Museum of Modern Art that he bought during his first visit to New York. Through this work, Bonillas not only makes central imagery that was once at the fringes, but he also demonstrates the malleable nature of their meaning.

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